



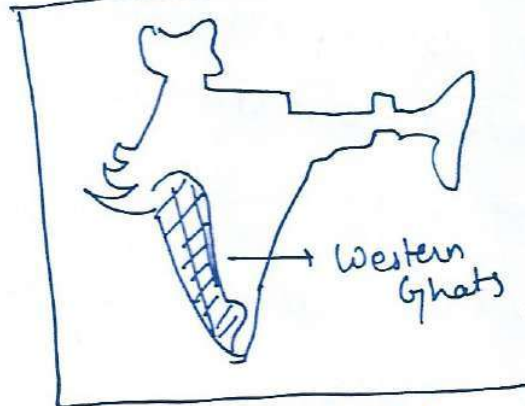
Q7) The Western Ghats, identified as one of the world's eight hot hotspots of biological diversity are a treasure trove of both biodiversity and economic value. Discuss.

(10 Marks, 150 Words)

पश्चिमी घाट, जिसे दुनिया की जैविक विविधता के आठ हॉट स्पॉट में से एक के रूप में पहचाना जाता है, जैव विविधता और आर्थिक दृष्टिकोण दोनों रूपों में मूल्यवान हैं। चर्चा करें। (10 अंक, 150 शब्द)

Western Ghats are a rich repository of biodiversity spread across 7 States.

It is considered as a treasure trove of biodiversity as:



- ① Home to many endemic species of India eg. Malabar civet, Nilgiri Tahr.
- ② Consists of Tropical Evergreen forests which is a rich habitat for diverse trees - eg. Ebony, Mahogany etc.
- ③ It also consists of reptiles, insects and rare butterflies. eg. Mahabali frog.
- ④ It is also home to many tribes in South India eg. Sholavai, Kummi tribes, Erular tribes.

- ⑤ The landscape is spotted with hills, peaks and waterfalls constituting of protected areas. eg. Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve

Economic Value

1. It has huge hydro-electric potential
eg. Malampuzha Dam in Kerala.
2. Scope for tourism industry is immense. eg. wildlife safaris in Bandipur
3. The ~~so~~ trees in the region have high timber value.
4. Source of many minerals found in the Ghats.

The right balance needs to be found to sustain its both values and to maintain its status as a World Heritage Site.

Feedback (For OFFICE use only)

Structure		Content	
Question Interpretation		Total :	